



Project Sonic 2017

SEGA has announced and released a teaser trailer for Project Sonic
dgit.in/ProSonic17



No more Cyanogen OS

Cyanogen has reportedly fired its OS development arm and switched to apps
dgit.in/CyanoXos

Origins

its evolution from basic characters to pictographic content. For one, each image shared over messages was much larger than emojis, which made it difficult for operators to handle the peak time traffic of messages. Emojis were also more fun and convenient, as they were no longer disjointed structures of special symbols and characters, but faces depicting



The iPhone was compelled to include emojis in Japan

regular emotions. Prior to emoji and emoticons, adding tone to a text message was difficult, which often led to conflicting interpretation of messages between the sender and receiver.

THE IMPACT

The rise of online chat rooms and the primary forms of instant messaging saw the relevance of emojis. With casual chats, the need for easy depiction of reactions became tantamount, which led to a rising count of emojis, and their overall refinement. The rise of WhatsApp and the advent of smartphones was crucial to the massive expansion of emoji use, which grew at a steady yet slow pace until then.

Better accessibility to the internet, advent of mobile internet with smartphones and the integration of third party services on devices saw a large section of users engaging with emojis, lending a deeper, easier-to-understand tone to

interpersonal messaging. One of the most notable impacts that emojis had, before becoming pivotal to the present advertising and marketing industry, was on the iPhone, in Japan. With Jobs' refusal to play along with other companies, Apple was surprised with the amount of features that were regular to the 80 million people using smartphones back in 2007, and yet, were missing from the iPhone. With most operators turning down a partnership deal with Apple owing to the lack of features, it was Vodafone Japan that picked up the contract deal, under clauses that the next update to the iPhone would include emojis for users in Japan. Since then, emojis have become a staple and grown exponentially.

With us moving into the second decade of this millennium, the presence of emojis in a message has become even more relevant to those born around or after the year 2000. Marketers and advertisers started capitalising on communication trends in an online-first world to present messages, ad campaigns and slogans which involved emojis. Advertising in the digital age was impacted by emoji campaigns, which were deemed not only more effective, but imparted more relatability and a deeper sense of connection for target audiences.

THE GRADUAL DIVERSIFICATION

Like every element gradually diversifies after becoming popular, emojis have diversified manifold. The faces have evolved, new expressions have been added, and the world of emojis have gone way beyond mere emotions, to now include sports, flags, differences in races and even celebrities. Emojis are now a discourse that even has statistical analysts breaking down how nations generally feel,



We will not judge you if you use these

which activity is the most popular, and an overall sense of needing to be politically correct with your reactions.

Notable diversification of emojis include the marginal differences in the original Emoji, the ones used by Twitter, and the likes of celebrity emojis like 'Kimoji' (by Kim Kardashian) and 'Boltmoji' by celebrity athlete Usain Bolt. A recent study has scaled the rise of diverse emojis, accounting for a whopping 609-percent year-on-year increase in the use of emojis in the marketing industry. As of May 2016, 800 million emoji messages were used in the field of marketing and advertisement, as opposed to only 145 million in May 2015. The effectiveness is being realised now, with millennials regarding brands that employ emojis as more relatable.



What India tweeted on World Emoji Day

EMOTING OUT LOUD

Emojis are no longer casual pictographic depictions to ease messaging tones, they are a part of everyday communication. Statistical analysis on emojis make way for consensus on how a population is generally feeling, paving the way for sociological research and data collection.

Our generation is all about emoting out loud, of expressing loudly and clearly about who we are, what we prefer, we like, dislike and even when we are in love. What started as a crucial tool to ease communication servers and attract more users to the network is now a tool that seamlessly fits into our generally expressive social media presence. Here's raising a toast to the millions of familiar faces – the past, present and expansive future of emojis.